

Chapter 4: Intro to UI/UX (The Artist) - Guided Notes

Name: _____ Date: __ Class/Period: __

Essential Question:

How does a UI/UX designer use psychology and digital prototyping tools to create intuitive and aesthetically pleasing interfaces?

PART 1: The Psychology of Design

1. Visual Hierarchy: Visual Hierarchy is the deliberate arrangement of elements to imply _____. You want to guide the user's eye to the Primary CTA (Call to _____) first.

- We achieve hierarchy by manipulating **Scale** (Size) and _____ (Color differences).
- Designers use the "**Squint Test**" to quickly evaluate if their hierarchy is working.

2. Cognitive Load & Spacing:

- **Cognitive Load:** The amount of _____ effort required by a user to understand an interface.
- **White Space:** Also known as negative space. This is the empty "breathing room" around elements used to reduce cognitive load.

PART 2: Color Theory & Typography

3. Color Psychology: Colors evoke subconscious emotional responses.

- **Blue:** Often represents _____ and security (used heavily by banks).
- **Red:** Often represents urgency, errors, or danger.
- **The 60-30-10 Rule:** A standard UI palette consists of 60% Primary Color, 30% Secondary Color, and 10% _____ Color (used for buttons).

4. Typography:

- _____: Fonts with small decorative "feet" or strokes at the ends of the letters (traditional/formal).
- **Sans-**_____: Fonts without the decorative feet. Generally considered more modern and cleaner for digital screens.
- **Leading:** The vertical spacing between lines of text (Line-Height).

- **Kerning:** The horizontal spacing between individual characters.

PART 3: Figma Foundations & Components

5. UI Prototyping: While a Wireframe is a black-and-white sketch, a _____ **-Fidelity (Hi-Fi) Mockup** includes the final colors, typography, and actual images. We use cloud tools like _____ to build these without writing code.

6. Professional Organization:

- **The Layer Stack:** The order of elements from front to back. A button's text must sit _____ the background shape layer to be visible.
- **Professional Decorum:** You must name your design layers clearly (e.g., `submit-btn`). Leaving layers named "Rectangle 4" causes chaos for the developers writing the code.

7. Reusable Assets: A reusable master element in Figma (like a standard navigation bar) is called a _____. If you update the 'Master' version, it automatically updates all instances of it across the entire design file.

8. Interactive Prototyping: Prototyping allows you to create a clickable simulation of the final app. You connect screens using a _____ (the user action, like a Click or Hover) that starts an animation or screen change.



CORNELL SUMMARY

Summary Prompt: In 3-4 complete sentences, explain what Visual Hierarchy is and how a designer uses concepts like Scale, Contrast, and White Space to guide a user through a webpage.